

SKILLS GUIDE



Good team-working skills to deal with artists and producers, often under intense time pressure.



A good knowledge of operating a mixing console and other equipment to set sound levels.



Scrupulous attention to detail for monitoring audio signals and keeping a log of all recordings.



Physical strength for setting up equipment in a studio or on location at concerts and events.



Excellent computer skills to operate state-of-the art digital systems for recording music.



Flexibility to work the long hours needed to accommodate performers and events.



SOUND DESIGNER Takes responsibility for the entire sound of a production, which may be a film, video, or computer game. Sound engineers create and edit music and sound effects, using a range of digital equipment.



MUSIC PRODUCER Brings together artists, songwriters, and technical know-how to create an original recorded work. Many music producers work for record companies or are hired by artists who are looking for a distinctive sound.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **BROADCAST ENGINEER** Sets up and operates the sophisticated electronic systems used in TV, radio, and other digital media broadcasts. Broadcast engineers work as part of a team with producers and presenters in recording studios, control rooms, or on location in all weather conditions. They also oversee the updating and repair of equipment, installing hardware, software, and other digital systems.
- ▶ **LIGHTING ENGINEER** Prepares, sets up, and operates the lighting equipment for TV, film, or video productions, and live events, such as concerts and theater productions. An excellent understanding of the effects achieved with different types of lighting is essential for any lighting engineer.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Electronics • Sound technology • Music • Physics • Mathematics • Computers



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A relevant degree is desirable, but good technical skills and experience can get you started in this career.



LIFESTYLE Hours can be long and irregular. Sound engineers may be expected to work at night when studio time is less expensive.



LOCATION Sound engineers may work in a studio or on location at concerts, on a film set, or at another live event. They may have to travel extensively.



THE REALITIES The work can be demanding, but working as part of a creative team with talented artists can be highly rewarding.